

Chapter 18

Instructor's Manual

This chapter covers:

- The selectivity of language subordination
- The impossibility of creating one homogenous English
- A discussion of what can or should be done about language subordination
- A discussion of what language subordination is and is not

Sample answers to the questions from the text and the website

From the website

Video

“Where is the Love?: A Project on Language Discrimination”

Directed by Jason Millar, Melanie Martin, Monica Bergeron, and Shanti Ernest

<http://whohasmyfedora.wordpress.com/>

1. What do you think about this project's goals to spread the word about linguistic discrimination? Do you think this is an effective way to make people aware of language subordination?

Sample answer: I think this is a very cool project. I like how they chose a popular song with a message encouraging social change in order to link linguistic discrimination with racial discrimination, and I think the use of music does help the viewer feel more emotion about this issue. In addition, the interviews in the video help the viewer feel the emotions that the interviewees have felt in their experiences with linguistic discrimination. I think this helps people who speak something close to *SAE remember that linguistic discrimination is not an abstract topic that is only found in academic studies—it happens to and hurts real people. I also like that the makers of this video recruited a diverse group of people who speak English with a variety of accents to participate. I think this kind of project is important for educating people about linguistic discrimination, and I think it would be an important step forward to have more large-scale and publicized projects like this that would reach a wider audience in order to inspire people to think critically about linguistic discrimination and language subordination.

Suggested activities and discussion questions

1. Ask your students what they think can and/or should be done about language subordination. Why do they feel the way they do? If they propose social changes, what kind of resources and timeline would be involved? Who would be involved in enacting the change? Is there anything they think they can or should do in their own lives to help make a change?

2. To enhance discussion of this chapter, please visit the companion website and check out the audio and video clips available for use in your classroom.